

Cash & Clearance Arithmetic

Money math that changes Friday decisions. Not textbook finance - the numbers that keep you honest about wage era, deposit, and quit trigger.

Source: General subject pack (Gate-tied) - companion to docs 08, 09

One sentence

Cash arithmetic is how you refuse fantasy runway: every dollar either ends wage era or it is theater.

The SKUs that matter

- Diligence deposit: \$2,500 due now -> 72h written find on may-gaps. Review band often quoted \$5k-\$8k after deposit - do not invent higher without a real seat.
- Bind Room: \$1,750 - examiner pack / stranger-openable halt artifacts. Not a weld.
- Quit trigger (locked): paid Clear - \$2,500 diligence OR \$1,750 Bind. Replies are not Clear.
- Operator / register / weld: fortune lane later. Do not budget it as this month's rent.

Gross vs what hits the account

Stripe (card) typically takes about 2.9% + \$0.30 per successful charge in the US. Always check your Dashboard - numbers drift by country and method.

- \$2,500 diligence $\approx$ \$2,500 - $(0.029 \times 2500 + 0.30) \approx$ \$2,427 net before tax/tooling.
- \$1,750 Bind $\approx$ \$1,750 - $(0.029 \times 1750 + 0.30) \approx$ \$1,699 net.
- Two diligence Clears $\approx$ \$4,850 net - enough to feel surplus start, not enough to cosplay holdco.
- Render / domain / tools (~\$30-\$50) are not optional if the mouth is dark. Pay the surface before you mourn fee drag.

Wage-era burn (honest)

- Amazon/warehouse take-home ~\$470/wk is the floor you are escaping - not a personality.
- Weekly burn for Gate while employed should stay tiny: hosting + one tool, not lifestyle.
- Do not quit on pipeline vibes. Quit on paid Clear only.
- If net after fees cannot cover a month of living without wage, you are still in wage era. Say that out loud.

Unit economics of one send

- Cost of a tight send: minutes + reputation. Spray of 40 sludge emails has negative unit economics.
- Quality pack (~20-25) beats volume: each entity should have a specific irreversible write named.
- Expected value of one DEPOSIT ask is not reply rate - it is probability of paid Clear x net fee.
- One paid Clear beats fifty 'interesting, circle back' threads.

Deposit vs review vs weld

Deposit: Money now that buys a defined find. Scarcity signal. Your Friday product.

Review: Follow-on if the find matters. Do not sell it as free after soft chat.

Weld / exclusive: Fortune path when a real irreversible mouth sits exclusive. Not the first invoice you chase this week.

Tax and entity (floor, not CPA advice)

- Nisaba LLC receives the money - keep personal and LLC separate in your head and your bank.
- Set aside a rough tax slice of net (often ~25-30% as a crude personal buffer until a real accountant). Better than spending gross like it is free.
- This is not tax advice. It is anti-delusion: Clear cash is not 100% spendable lifestyle.

Retrieval drill

- Net of one \$2,500 after $\sim 2.9\% + \$0.30$.
- Quit trigger amounts - both of them.
- Why replies do not count as Clear.
- Why fee drag does not excuse skipping Render.

What this is not

- Not MBA valuation theater
- Not permission to delay Friday outbound until you finish a finance book
- Not claiming revenue you have not collected